

PROPERACCESS

DIGITAL ACCESSIBILITY

Action plan zwemwater.nl website

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1. How accessible is your website?

Our evaluation shows that the zwemwater.nl website currently still contains barriers for visitors with disabilities. We made a total of 45 findings.

Total findings	45
High-impact issues	25
Medium-impact issues	16
Low-impact issues	4
Advisories	0
Technical issues	35
Content issues	10

Of the 45 findings, 25 are high impact. These are issues that directly prevent visitors with disabilities from using the website, or make it very hard to.

The vast majority (35 of 45) are technical issues to be handled by the development team. The remaining 10 are content-related and can largely be handled by the web editors.

2. Who is most affected?

Accessibility issues do not affect everyone in the same way. Below we explain which groups of visitors are most hindered by the issues we found.

Blind and low-vision visitors

This is usually the group that is hit hardest. Blind visitors use a screen reader: software that reads the content of a web page aloud. Visitors with low vision struggle with contrast issues, small text, and focus indicators that are not visible enough.

Visitors with a motor impairment

Visitors who cannot use a mouse navigate with the keyboard, a switch, or voice control. They benefit from full keyboard operation, a visible focus indicator, and click areas that are large enough.

Visitors with a cognitive impairment

Visitors with a cognitive impairment, including dyslexia, benefit from clear structure, predictable behavior, and readable text. They need time and clear error messages.

Deaf and hard-of-hearing visitors

Deaf and hard-of-hearing visitors benefit from captions, transcripts, and text alternatives for audio content.

3. The biggest issues

Below are the issues with the most impact. These are the things that most severely hinder the use of the website.

Keyboard focus moves outside the dialog

When a visitor opens the website for the first time, a cookie dialog appears. Currently, keyboard focus can escape the open dialog and move to the page content underneath. As long as the dialog is open, keyboard focus must stay within it.

Expandable menu item and submenu are built with an incorrect ARIA structure

In the main navigation menu, the "About us" menu item contains an expandable submenu. Both the expandable menu item and the submenu it opens are built incorrectly.

Submenu is not keyboard accessible

The main menu in this website's header contains a submenu that opens with "About us" and cannot be operated with the keyboard. Submenus must be fully keyboard accessible. Visitors must be able to open, move through, and select items in submenus using only the keyboard. In addition, the information in these submenus must be accessible to all visitors, regardless of whether they use a mouse or keyboard. Finally, the pages the submenu items link to should contain all the information that is in the submenus themselves. Information must not be available exclusively within the submenu.

Button cannot be operated with Space and Enter

On this page, the numbered and icon buttons on the map are not keyboard accessible. They cannot be activated with the Space bar or the Enter key. All buttons must be operable with both the Space bar and the Enter key. This is the standard keyboard interaction for buttons and essential for visitors who rely on keyboard navigation.

Status message is not announced by screen readers

This page has a search feature that updates the results automatically as the visitor types. When a search returns no results, the message "Sorry, no results found" appears on screen. However, this message is not announced automatically by screen readers. Although the search results area is

marked as a live region, content changes are not announced reliably by screen readers. As a result, screen reader users may not notice that the search has finished and that no results were found. Visitors have to navigate through the page manually to discover that the results have changed.

Chart information is only available on mouse hover

On this page, activating a swimming location opens a dialog with measurement charts in the "Measurement data" tab. Additional information about individual measurements is shown in a tooltip when a visitor hovers over chart elements with the mouse. This information is not available to visitors who do not use a mouse. Keyboard users may not be able to reach the values, and screen reader users may not be told that additional information exists or be able to request it.

Focus is lost after the search results update

This page has a search field under "Search by swimming spot or place name" that updates the search results automatically as the visitor types. When a search term changes the results, keyboard focus is lost. As a result, keyboard and screen reader users lose their place on the page and have to navigate back to the search field or the results to continue. Because this only happens when the results actually change, the issue can seem inconsistent and hard to predict.

Keyboard focus is not visible on the button

On this page, the numbered and icon buttons on the map have no visible keyboard focus indicator. Visitors who use only the keyboard need a clear visual cue to know which element has focus and when they can activate a button.

4. Components with the most issues

The issues are not evenly distributed. Some components contain a strikingly high number of findings. By tackling these first, you solve the largest number of issues at once.

- Home (map and search) (16 findings)
- On all pages (14 findings)
- Five tips for safely getting on the water in 2026 (5 findings)

5. Action plan for the development team

Below are the findings to be handled by the developers, grouped by topic. Address them in order of impact: high-impact issues first, then medium, then low.

Focus order (SC 2.4.3)

- Keyboard focus moves outside the dialog
- Focus is lost after the search results update

- Keyboard focus leaves the open dialog
- Filter menu does not work well with the keyboard
- Keyboard focus order is not logical

Accessible names and roles (SC 4.1.2)

- Expandable menu item and submenu are built with an incorrect ARIA structure
- Disabled filter controls lose their role and state
- Dialog has no role=dialog and no name
- Element with role="application" has no accessible name
- Accessible name of an iframe is missing

Structure and semantics (SC 1.3.1, 4.1.2)

- Heading does not have the correct markup
- Empty navigation landmark is exposed to assistive technology
- Incorrect ARIA roles and structure in the navigation menu
- The relationship between breadcrumb items is not defined in the code

Alt text and images (SC 1.1.1, 2.4.4, 2.5.3, 4.1.2)

- The logo's text is not in the accessible name
- Logos have no text alternative (the alt attribute is empty)
- Link has no accessible name
- The link to remove a filter has an unclear accessible name

Keyboard and touch operation (SC 2.1.1)

- Submenu is not keyboard accessible
- Button cannot be operated with Space and Enter
- Chart information is only available on mouse hover

Heading and button text (SC 2.4.6)

- The button's name does not describe what the button does
- Buttons with the same accessible name perform different functions

Focus not obscured (SC 2.4.11)

- Keyboard focus is covered by the dialog

Status messages (SC 4.1.3)

- Status message is not announced by screen readers

Focus indicator (SC 2.4.7)

- Keyboard focus is not visible on the button

Other (SC 1.3.2)

- The reading order is not meaningful

Language changes (SC 3.1.2)

- Part of the content is in another language, but no language code is applied

Single-character shortcuts (SC 2.1.4)

- Single-character keyboard shortcuts are present

6. Action plan for the design team

Below are the findings to be handled by the design team. The solutions often lie in design tokens (colors, contrast, spacing) and in testing the design at different viewports and zoom levels.

UI component contrast (SC 1.4.11)

- Custom keyboard focus indicator has insufficient color contrast

Text color contrast (SC 1.4.3)

- Text contrast is lower than 4.5:1

Text resize (SC 1.4.4)

- Content is lost when zooming to 200%

Reflow / responsive (SC 1.4.10)

- Zoom 400% and content is lost

7. Action plan for the web editors

Below are the findings to be handled by the web editors, grouped by topic. Most items can be addressed independently, separate from the development team.

Structure and semantics (SC 1.3.1)

- Heading does not have the correct markup
- em used only for visual emphasis

- strong used only for visual emphasis

Alt text and images (SC 1.1.1, 2.5.3)

- Not all visible text in the logo is in the text alternative
- Visible text on the images is not in the text alternative

Other (SC 1.2.2, 1.2.3, 1.2.5)

- Visual information in the video is not accessible
- Automatically generated captions

8. Recommendation: replace external components

With external components, there is a good chance the vendor will not address the issue. Ask anyway, for your compliance file, but do not count on it. In parallel, start selecting an accessible alternative right away. When selecting, look at: keyboard operation, focus management, sufficient contrast, heading structure, and correct roles for dialogs.

- Video player
- Cookie banner
- Interactive swimming water map

Questions about this plan?

Feel free to get in touch. We are happy to help think through the best approach for your site or app.

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